

Retirement Planning in Plain English - Printable Worksheets

From *Retirement Planning in Plain English: The 2027 Guide* by Daniel Marsh (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

B1 - The retirement budget

Expense	Now (monthly)	In retirement (monthly)	Fixed (F) or flexible (X)
Mortgage or rent			F
Property tax, insurance, HOA			F
Home maintenance and repairs (1-2% of value a year)			F
Utilities, phone, internet			F
Food and household			F
Health insurance			F

premiums (bridge plan / Medicare, Medigap, Part D)			
Medical out of pocket, dental, vision, hearing			F
Medicines			F
Car(s): payment, insurance, fuel, maintenance			F
Life, long-term care, umbrella insurance			F
Income taxes (estimated)			F
Debt payments			F
Travel and vacations			X
Eating out, entertainment, hobbies			X
Gifts, family support, charity			X
Clothing, personal			X

Other			
Total			
Fixed subtotal			
Flexible subtotal			

B2 - The net worth statement

Asset	Owner (me / spouse / joint)	Type (taxable / tax- deferred / tax-free)	Value	Income it produces (annual)
Social Security (me): at 62 / FRA / 70			(see Chapter 2 for the value)	
Social Security (spouse)				
Pension(s)				
401(k) / 403(b) / TSP (each)				
Traditional IRA(s)				
Roth IRA / Roth 401(k)				
HSA				
Taxable brokerage				
Bank, CDs, savings bonds				

House (value less mortgage less 7%)				
Other property, business, life insurance cash value				
Total assets				

Debt	Balance	Rate	Payment	Paid off by
Mortgage				
Home equity line				
Car loan(s)				
Credit cards				
Other				
Total debts				

B3 - The gap and the number

Annual budget in retirement (B1 total x 12)	
Guaranteed income: Social Security (at planned claiming ages)	
Guaranteed income: pension(s), annuity	
Total guaranteed income	
The gap (budget minus guaranteed income)	
Years before Social Security starts, and the larger gap in those years	
The number: gap x 25 (conservative)	
The number: gap x 20 (flexible spending)	
Savings today (B2, tax-adjusted: reduce tax-deferred balances by about 20-25%)	
Shortfall or surplus	

Levers if short: work longer / claim later / cut fixed expenses / the house / part-time	
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B4 - The income floor

Fixed expense (from B1)	Annual amount
Total fixed	

Guaranteed income source	Annual amount	Indexed to inflation?	Survivor keeps?
Social Security (higher earner, at age ___)		yes	yes (the larger)
Social Security (lower earner, at age ___)		yes	no
Pension (survivor option ___%)			
Annuity (if bought)			
Total floor			
Floor minus fixed			

expenses			
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B5 - The Social Security decision

	Me	Spouse
Full retirement age		
Benefit at 62 / FRA / 70		
Higher earner?		
Planned claiming age, and why		
Bridge: what funds the years before claiming		
Earnings test: any work before FRA?		
Survivor: what the survivor would receive under this plan		

B6 - The withdrawal order and spending rule

Spending rule (4% with guardrails / buckets / life-expectancy / other)	
Starting withdrawal rate and dollar amount	
Guardrails: cut 10% if the rate exceeds ____%; raise 10% if it falls below ____%	
Cash bucket: years of withdrawals held in cash ____; refilled each ____	
Target taxable income bracket each year	
Cliffs to stay under: IRMAA ____ / Social Security tax zone / ACA cliff / senior deduction	
Order this year: RMD ____; taxable ____; tax-deferred ____; Roth ____	
Monthly "paycheck" transfer amount and date	

Withholding arranged on: pension / IRA withdrawals / Social Security (W- 4V)	
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B7 - The house decision

	Stay	Downsize	Move
Annual cost (tax, insurance, maintenance, utilities, HOA)			
Equity released (sale price minus 7% minus mortgage minus new home cost)			
Capital gains tax on the sale (gain above \$250,000 / \$500,000 x 15%)			
Effect on fixed expenses			
Distance to family and hospital			
Property tax relief available			
Decision and date			

B8 - Roth conversion planner

Year	Age(s)	Expected taxable income before conversion	Room to top of ____% bracket	IRMAA threshold (2 years ahead)	ACA cliff (if under 65)	Conversion amount	Tax, paid from

B9 - The long-term care plan

Cost of a year of care where I live (home care / assisted living / nursing home)	
Insurance in place (type, benefit, waiting period, premium)	
Portfolio reserve designated for care	
The house as a reserve: yes / no; the spouse's protection	
Medicaid: likely / unlikely; elder-law consultation done on	
Family: who, what they could and could not do	
The plan, in two sentences	

B10 - The beneficiary and document audit

Account or document	Current beneficiary / agent	Updated on	Contingent
401(k) / 403(b)			
Traditional IRA			
Roth IRA			
Life insurance			
Annuity			
Bank accounts (POD added?)			
Brokerage (TOD added?)			
House (joint / TOD deed / trust)			
Will (executor)			
Durable power of attorney (agent)			
Health care proxy			

Living will			
Trusted contact on each account			

B11 - Questions for an adviser

Question	Answer
Are you a fiduciary at all times? In writing?	
How are you paid, in dollars, for a household like mine?	
What are the total costs of the investments you recommend?	
Your investment philosophy in two sentences	
How do you handle Social Security claiming, Roth conversions, withdrawal order, and the December tax projection?	
Who is your typical client?	
What happens if you retire or die?	
Can I see a sample plan?	
BrokerCheck / SEC record checked on	

B12 - The one-page plan

1. Retirement date(s)	
2. Budget: total / fixed / flexible	
3. Floor: Social Security ages, pension, annuity; covers fixed expenses?	
4. Gap per year; the number	
5. Portfolio: accounts, mix, cash bucket, funds	
6. Withdrawal order and spending rule	
7. Roth conversion plan	
8. Healthcare: bridge / Medicare choice / HSA	
9. Long-term care: how paid	
10. The house	
11. Insurance kept / dropped	
12. Estate: documents, beneficiaries,	

probate avoidance, the folder	
13. People: adviser, CPA, trusted contact, who knows the plan	
14. Signals to reopen the plan	
Reviewed on (December each year)	